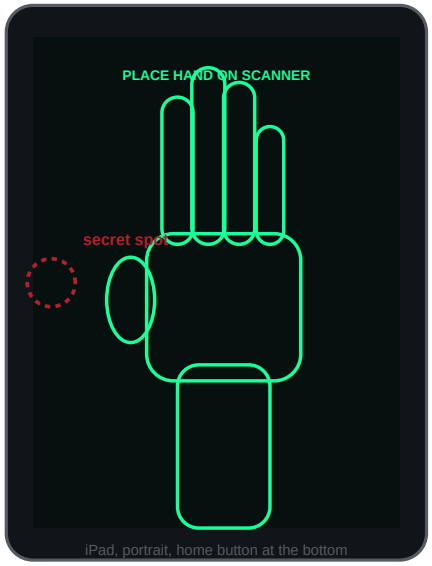
Biometric Hand Scanner

iPad setup & operating guide (Halloween prop)

Open this address in **Safari** on the iPad, or scan the code:
`https://angus-42.github.io/Halloweentrail/`

1 Install (one time, needs Wi-Fi)

1. Connect the iPad to Wi-Fi and open the link in **Safari** (it must be Safari, not Chrome).
2. Wait until the small text at the bottom-right of the screen says **OFFLINE READY**.
3. Tap the **Share** button (square with an arrow), scroll down, tap **Add to Home Screen**, then **Add**.
4. Close Safari. Open the new **Hand Scanner** icon on the home screen. It should fill the whole screen with no address bar.
5. Leave it open for 10 seconds while still on Wi-Fi, then you are done. Wi-Fi is never needed again.



2 Prove it works offline

1. Turn on **Airplane Mode** (Control Center).
2. Swipe up to close the app completely, then open it again from the icon.
3. It should appear within a second or two and still say OFFLINE READY. If it does, it will work anywhere.

3 How the trick works

- Anyone who puts a hand flat on the glowing outline gets the full scan: beam, fingerprints, progress bar, then red **ACCESS DENIED - UNAUTHORIZED CIVILIAN** and a buzzer.
- To get green **CLEARANCE GRANTED** (Sergeant Bushmaster, Hazmat Response Unit), touch **the secret spot with your left thumb**: halfway down the **left edge** of the glass, right where a thumb rests when you hold the iPad in your left hand. Tap it up to 6 seconds before the hand lands or while the scan runs. A quick tap-and-release is enough.
- That thumb never shows a marker on screen, and touching the spot by itself does nothing, so nobody can discover it by accident. Careful: if your thumb is resting on the spot while a *guest* scans, the guest gets cleared too. Hold the iPad by the bezel, or set it on a stand, for guests.
- On success a large flashing PROCEED TO DR. STEIN IMMEDIATELY! appears and the voice says the same; on denial it flashes RETURN TO THE PERIMETER.
- The scanner resets by itself a couple of seconds after the hand is lifted. Nothing to press between guests.

4 Set the iPad up for the night

1. **Settings > Display & Brightness > Auto-Lock > Never.** Otherwise the screen goes dark.
2. Brightness up, Silent switch off (if the iPad has one), volume most of the way up. Sound starts on the first touch.
3. **Settings > Accessibility > Guided Access > On**, and set a passcode. Then open Hand Scanner, **triple-click the top/side button**, tap **Start**. Now a palm cannot swipe out of the app. To exit later: triple-click again and enter the passcode.
4. Plug it in. A full night of screen-on time at high brightness will drain a battery.
5. Mount it flat or at a shallow angle so a whole hand can rest on it. A stand with a lip under the bottom edge helps.

5 Settings (press and HOLD the faint gear, top-left, for 2 seconds)

- **Outcome**: "Denied unless the secret spot is also touched" is the default. Other choices: always granted, always denied, random, alternating.
- **Secret spot**: move it to another edge or corner, or choose Custom and tap **Set by tapping**, then touch the screen where you want it. **Reveal spot 5 s** shows it so you can practice.
- **Fingers needed to trigger**: 3 by default. If a flat hand does not start a scan, lower it to 2.
- **Names**: the list of people it "recognizes", one per line, picked at random. It is set to Sergeant Bushmaster only.
- **Spoken lines** and sound / voice toggles. Settings are saved on the iPad.
- Tap **Save & close**. The gear is dim and a quick tap does nothing, so a thumb brushing it while you hold the iPad will not open it. Turn Guided Access on after you finish adjusting.

6 If something is off

What you see	What to do
Address bar or Safari buttons visible	You opened it in Safari. Close Safari and open it from the home-screen icon instead.
Bottom-right says CACHING… or OFFLINE CACHE FAILED	Stay on Wi-Fi, close and reopen the app. Wait for OFFLINE READY before leaving Wi-Fi.
Hand on the plate does nothing	Spread fingers and press flat. If still nothing, gear > Fingers needed > 2.
No sound, or sound stopped after the iPad sat idle	Touch the screen once; the audio engine wakes on the next touch. Check volume and that the iPad is not muted in Control Center. In Guided Access, make sure the volume buttons are not disabled in its Options. The spoken lines are recorded audio stored with the app, not live speech, so they need no network.
Everyone gets GRANTED	Gear > Outcome is not on the secret-spot setting. Change it and Save.
Screen keeps dimming	Auto-Lock is not set to Never, or Low Power Mode is on.

Works on any iPad running iPadOS 16.4 or newer. Nothing is installed from the App Store and nothing is sent anywhere; the page runs entirely on the iPad once added to the home screen. Questions: Adam Hickok.